

Nayeon Kim

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RESEARCH INTEREST

I conduct research in *computational linguistics*, *Korean NLP*, and the *development of AI grounded in human moral commonsense*.

- **How can linguistic knowledge inform better computational models of language?**

I am interested in multidisciplinary research aimed at truly understanding humans and developing beneficial AI systems, with a particular focus on integrating linguistics with computer science.

- **How do humans form implicit moral commonsense, and can AI internalize it?**

Beyond language itself, I focus on extracting implicit social norms into explicit data and training AI systems on them to computationally model the internal mechanisms of human moral cognition.

EDUCATION

Korea University, Seoul, Republic of Korea

Sep. 2021 – Aug. 2026

Ph.D. in Computer Science and Engineering

- Dissertation: *Incorporating Linguistic Knowledge into Korean Natural Language Processing*

- Advisor: Prof. SangKeun Lee

Kyungpook National University, Daegu, Republic of Korea

Mar. 2010 – Aug. 2015

B.A. in Korean Language and Literature

HONORS & AWARDS

- **Research Challenge Program Grant**, Brain Korea 21 Project
Funded by the National Research Foundation of Korea (NRF) Aug. 2024 – Feb. 2026
- **Junior Fellow Research Grant**, Brain Korea 21 Project
Funded by the National Research Foundation of Korea (NRF) Mar. 2024 – Dec. 2024
- **Ph.D. Fellowship**
Funded by the National Research Foundation of Korea (NRF) Sep. 2023 – Aug. 2025

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

* denotes equal contribution (Co-first author)

1. Sungho Kim*, **Nayeon Kim***, Taehee Jeon, and SangKeun Lee. “Polishing Every Facet of the GEM: Testing Linguistic Competence of LLMs and Humans in Korean.” In *Proceedings of the 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL 2025)*.
DOI: [10.18653/v1/2025.acl-long.492](https://doi.org/10.18653/v1/2025.acl-long.492)
2. **Nayeon Kim***, Eojin Jeon*, Jun-Hyung Park, and SangKeun Lee. “Handling Korean Out-of-Vocabulary Words with Phoneme Representation Learning.” In *Advances in Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining (PAKDD 2025)*.
DOI: [10.1007/978-981-96-8180-8-38](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-96-8180-8-38)
3. **Nayeon Kim***, Jun-Hyung Park*, Joon-Young Choi, Eojin Jeon, Youjin Kang, and SangKeun Lee. “Break it Down into BTS: Basic, Tiniest Subword Units for Korean.” In *Proceedings of the 2022 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP 2022)*.
DOI: [10.18653/v1/2022.emnlp-main.472](https://doi.org/10.18653/v1/2022.emnlp-main.472)

REFERENCES

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Prof. Deok-ho Kim

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Prof. Kang-Min Kim

Professor, Department of Software Convergence
Kyung Hee University, Yongin, Republic of Korea
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